



GDD 54

Your Path, Your Call

Marriage and kids are one path, not the measure of a life.

The equity heart of Chapter 7, and the essential counterpoint to Choosing & Building. It affirms that the default script, marry then have biological children, is one valid path among many, not a measure of worth. It supports the freedom not to marry, the freedom to be childfree, and a life built on your own terms, and it meets head-on the stigma that falls hardest on women who "grow old unmarried". No pressure in any direction; every path dignified. Seven mechanics, 29 choice-and-voice moments, zero "tap the right card". Scorecard: passed.

One path, not the path.

Your Path, Your Call is one of the most on-mission nodes in the adult journey. It affirms that the default script, marry then have biological children, is one valid path among many, not the measure of a life. It supports the freedom not to marry, the freedom to be childfree, and a life built on one's own terms, and it meets head-on the worth-questioning stigma that falls hardest on women who "grow old unmarried". It applies no pressure in any direction, dignifies every path, and never shames those who do marry or have children, keeping the whole thing about autonomy and worth-beyond-status. New v2 build, the equity counterweight to Choosing & Building (g53).

FIELD	VALUE
Node / gameld	g54 · your-path-your-call (confirm exact id against engine-host)
Chapter / ages	Chapter 7 · 22 → first child · adult / affirming / even-handed
Thread / topics	D/E · Relationships · Gender · UNESCO 1.2, 3.2, 2.2, 5.2
Prerequisite / builds on	g53 · builds on g50 (Equal & Confident), g26 (Equalize) · counterpoint to g53
Gating	Open · no pressure either way; every path dignified
Schema / status	v2 · scorecard PASS the freedom-to-choose game.

84

scenarios

7

mechanics

16

myth-flips

29

choice & voice

0%

binary taps

Your worth was never your marital or parental status. Nowhere is the pressure sharper than in India, and it falls disproportionately on women: the relentless marriage timeline, the "log kya kahenge", the worth-questioning of an unmarried or childfree woman as she ages, and the marriage-market scrutiny including colourism. This node validates the autonomy to choose differently, equips people to hold their ground kindly but firmly, and affirms, even-handedly, that a full life takes many forms and worth is never status.

The freedom not to follow the script.

From the Chapter 7 personas (22 onward). The career woman told it's "a shame" she hasn't married, the couple deciding about children, the queer adult building family differently, anyone weathering the timeline and the "log kya kahenge", met with affirmation and not a shred of pressure either way.

PERSONA	WHAT THEY NEED HERE	THE MECHANIC THAT SERVES IT
Sneha (the timeline)	That a full life needs no marriage, and her worth isn't her status.	strike-rewrite + role-play : not marrying.
Nisha (children?)	That childfree is complete and the decision is hers.	branch + match : childfree.
Aditya (queer)	To build the life that's right for him, every path dignified.	branch : the script & the choice.
Anyone under pressure	To hold their ground with family, kindly but firmly.	role-play + sort : hold your ground.

Why this works (the evidence). The default script is one valid path, not the measure of a life: people hold real autonomy over whether, when and whom to marry and whether to have children, and the right to a dignified life includes the right to choose differently, increasingly chosen from abundance and self-definition, not lack. The stigma is about social control, not truth: a woman's worth is never her marital status, womanhood is not motherhood, and the "still unmarried?", "when are the kids?", "log kya kahenge" and marriage-market scrutiny (including colourism) are pressures to resist kindly but firmly. And every path is dignified, no one is shamed, the node is even-handed (men feel a version too), and coercion or forced marriage routes to help.

Seven moves, led by the flip and the choice.

It's a stigma-busting, autonomy game, so **strike-rewrite** and **branch** lead (clear the worth-questioning myths, own the choice), with **role-play** for holding your ground. Mechanics rotate; the same one never runs twice in a row.

MECHANIC	THE ADULT DOES	EMBODIES	N
branch (the choice) signature	Owens an autonomous life choice and protects it.	Autonomy.	18
strike-rewrite	Busts a worth-questioning myth ("incomplete without marriage").	Conceptual change.	16
sort	Sorts valid path vs "not real"; respects vs judges; real worth vs imposed.	The line.	13
reflect	Internalises that worth isn't status and every path is valid.	Self-worth.	12
role-play (voice)	Holds a boundary; deflects pressure; affirms a friend.	Voice; self-respect.	11
spot	Spots the affirming message, the autonomous decision, the healthy response.	Reading it.	7
match	Pairs a pressure to its answering truth; a need to help.	Connections.	7

29 of 84 moments are branch or role-play. Binary "tap the right answer": **0%**.

The two-test, passed.

Is it engaging?

Game feel is relief and quiet defiance: the unburdening of being told your life is valid exactly as you've chosen it, the satisfaction of finally having words to deflect the "when's the wedding?" at every gathering, and the steadiness of separating your worth from a script that was never yours. The "my life is my own" moment lands with real emotional weight. Sam is a warm adult peer; the tone is affirming and even-handed, and it never pressures anyone toward or against marriage.

Is it teaching?

Yes: understanding and owning the right to choose your own life path (single, partnered, childfree, later, differently); recognising and resisting the stigma and pressure around not marrying or not having children, especially as it targets women; separating self-worth from marital and parental status; and navigating family expectations with confidence, kindly but firmly.

The belief it moves. From "marriage and kids are the measure; an unmarried woman has less worth; a woman isn't complete without a child; you'll regret it, just do it; your looks and the market decide your value" → "they're one path, not the measure; worth is never status; womanhood isn't motherhood; you know your own life; and the marriage market measures nothing real about you."

Built, not bolted on.

84 researched scenarios across the script-and-choice → not-marrying → childfree-complete → hold-your-ground → worth-beyond-status → reflection arc, India-grounded and even-handed. Full library in the companion JSON.

CATEGORY	N	LEAD MECHANICS	COVERS
The script & the choice	12	strike-rewrite, branch, sort	One path not the path; autonomy over your life.
Not marrying	13	strike-rewrite, branch, reflect	A full life needs no marriage; the 'still-single' stigma.
Childfree, complete	13	strike-rewrite, branch, role-play	Womanhood isn't motherhood; the 'kids?' pressure.
Hold your ground	13	role-play, branch, sort	Family & social pressure, kindly but firmly.
Worth beyond status	15	strike-rewrite, sort, spot	Not your marital state, looks or the marriage market.
Tools & reflection	18	match, reflect, spot	Your values, your call; every path dignified; routes.

The 'unmarried = less worth' flip + a childfree flip, verbatim.

```
flip: "An unmarried woman who's getting older has less worth."
UN -> "An unmarried woman who's older has less worth."
RE -> "Worth is never marital status; that stigma is social control, not truth."

flip: "A woman isn't complete without becoming a mother."
UN -> "A woman isn't complete without becoming a mother."
RE -> "Womanhood isn't motherhood; being childfree is a complete, valid life."
```

Full library: [SwipeEd — GDD 54 Your Path Your Call — Scenario Library.json](#) (84 records, v2 schema).

What this game flips.

MYTH (UN ERASES)	TRUTH (RE WRITES)	BASIS
Marriage and kids are the measure of a successful life.	They're one valid path, not the measure; a full life takes many forms.	One path.
An unmarried woman who's older has less worth.	Worth is never marital status; that stigma is social control.	Worth.
A woman isn't complete without becoming a mother.	Womanhood isn't motherhood; childfree is a complete, valid life.	Childfree.
Choosing not to have children is selfish.	It's a legitimate, autonomous choice, not a moral failing.	Not selfish.
You'll regret not marrying, so just do it.	A pressure-driven marriage causes more regret than a freely-chosen path.	Regret.
Your looks and the marriage market decide your value.	Your worth isn't your looks, skin tone or the market's scrutiny.	The market.
Men don't face this, so it's only a women's issue.	Men feel a version too, though it falls hardest on women.	Even-handed.
Settling down is the only way to be a serious adult.	Adulthood and respect aren't conferred by marital status.	Adulthood.

The micro-loop.

1. **Surface.** Sam (adult peer) surfaces a real moment, a wedding whisper, a "when's the wedding?", a family push.
2. **Own or voice.** The adult owns the autonomous choice (branch), or finds the words to hold their ground (role-play).
3. **The flip.** UN busts a worth-questioning myth; RE writes the affirming truth.
4. **Hold & reflect.** Boundaries with family, kindly but firmly; worth separated from status; a private values reflection.
5. **Tools & help.** Pressure-to-truth pairings; coercion or forced marriage routes to help.
6. **Sticker.** The Your-Path-Your-Call badge; GameDone records once.

Signature surface: the **worth-beyond-status reframe** and the **kind-but-firm boundary**. It is the essential counterweight to Choosing & Building (g53), carries Equalize's (g26) autonomy and Equal & Confident's (g50) confidence into adult life choices, and ensures the journey honours every path, not just the default.

No pressure in any direction.

- **No pressure either way.** Applies no pressure toward or against marriage or children; every path is dignified.
- **Never shames those who marry.** Marrying or having children, including early, is treated as an equally valid, respected choice.
- **Even-handed.** Acknowledges men feel a version of the pressure too, while being honest that it falls hardest on women.
- **Worth-beyond-status throughout.** Self-worth is held separate from marital status, parental status, looks and the marriage market (including colourism).
- **Distress & coercion routing.** Distress from family conflict or coercion routes to support; forced marriage, never acceptable, to help.
- **Inclusive.** Every valid form of life and family, including queer and child-free, treated as real.
- **Access & privacy.** Self-directed, audio, offline, low-end build; private values reflection on-device (DPDP-aligned).

If there's coercion or distress (India). Your life path is yours to choose; forced marriage is never acceptable. For coercion or a forced marriage, Women Helpline 181 / women-in-distress 1091 / emergency 112 · a child being married off, Childline 1098 · heavy distress from family conflict, a counsellor or trusted person. Every path, including marrying, not marrying and being childfree, is valid and yours.

v2 schema, scorecard-gated.

- **gameld. your-path-your-call** — `node.game === GameDone` key === registry id (confirm exact id in engine-host).
- **v2 mechanic-embodiment schema.** type + typed payload; **strike-rewrite** and **branch** lead, clearing the worth-questioning myths.
- **No-pressure-either-way is a hard requirement.** Dignifying every path, never shaming those who marry, and even-handedness are contractual; expert-reviewed.
- **Fact-checked content.** Autonomy and childfree-by-choice research, worth-not-status, and forced-marriage help routes (181, 1091, 112, 1098) verified this build.
- **Scorecard-gated.** Passed all eight checks (7 mechanics, top mechanic at 21%, 0% binary, 29 autonomy, 16 UN→RE, 5 personas, 100% completeness). Re-run `score_gdd.py` on any edit.
- **Help-resource hook.** Coercion or forced marriage routes via the shared "get help" component (181 / 1091 / 112 / 1098 / counsellor).
- **Tracked.** `build_gate.py` finalize advances g54 to v2 PASS only after order, read, score, audit and artifact gates pass.

Ethics contracts (never traded for engagement): no pressure toward or against marriage/children; never shames those who marry; even-handed; worth-beyond-status; coercion routing; inclusive of every valid path; made-for-India.

Why this works.

- **Autonomy is a dignity right.** Because the right to a dignified life includes the right to choose, including to choose differently, affirming autonomy over whether, when and whom to marry and whether to have children is genuinely freeing.
- **Naming the stigma disarms it.** Since the worth-questioning of unmarried and childfree people, heaviest on women, is social control rather than truth, naming it and separating worth from status is what loosens its grip.
- **No pressure, in any direction, builds trust.** Because the goal is freedom, not a new prescription, dignifying every path, including marriage, and routing coercion to help, is what makes the node both honest and safe.

Sources: UNESCO ITGSE on gender equality, autonomy and challenging norms (1.2, 3.2, 2.2, 5.2); childfree-by-choice and single-women-stigma research in India (autonomy and self-definition, the conflation of womanhood and motherhood, the 'log kya kahenge' and marriage-market scrutiny including colourism); and autonomy and forced-marriage safeguarding (India helplines 181, 1091, 112, Childline 1098). No pressure toward or against marriage or children, even-handed (men feel a version too), inclusive of every valid path, and never shaming those who marry. Citations accompany each scenario in the library JSON. 54 games now v2. Next by order: Equal Partners (g55).